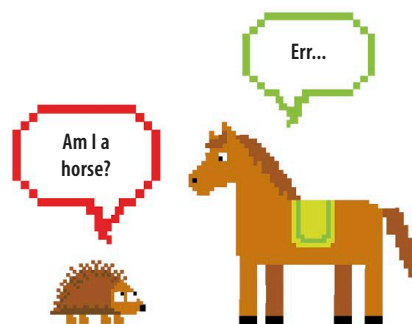


Making decisions

Every day you make decisions about what to do next, based on the answers to questions you ask yourself. For example, “Is it raining?”, “Have I done my homework?”, “Am I a horse?” Computers also make decisions by asking questions.



Questions that compare

The questions that computers ask themselves usually involve comparing one thing with another. For example, a computer might ask if one number is bigger than another. If it is, the computer might then decide to run a block of code that would otherwise be skipped.

▷ Boolean values

The answers to the questions computers ask have only two possible values: True or False. Python calls these two values Boolean values, and they must always start with a capital letter. You can store a Boolean value in a variable.

Variable

```
>>> answer_one = True
>>> answer_two = False
```

Boolean value

EXPERT TIPS

Equals signs

In Python, you can use a single equals sign, =, or a double equals sign, ==. They mean slightly different things. Use a single equals sign when you want to set the value of a variable. Typing `age = 10`, for example, sets the value of the variable `age` to 10. Use a double equals sign when you want to compare two values, as in the example below.

```
>>> age = 10
>>> if age == 10:
    print('You are ten years old.')
```

This sets the value of the variable.

This compares your age with the variable.

The code prints the message if the two match.

▽ Logical operators

These symbols tell computers to make comparisons. Programmers call them logical operators. You may have used some of them in maths. The words “and” and “or” can also be used as logical operators in computer code.

Symbol	Meaning
==	equal to
!=	not equal to
<	less than
>	greater than

